



AFTER

Victory at Antietam strengthened President Lincoln's political position—he issued the Preliminary Emancipation Proclamation just a few days later, on September 22.

LINCOLN'S TIMING

Lincoln had intended to proclaim **the freedom of Confederate slaves** (see [The Emancipation Proclamation](#)) during the summer, but had been advised that to do so at a **time of military setbacks** might smack of desperation. Now he saw his opportunity.

McCLELLAN'S INACTIVITY



LINCOLN AND McCLELLAN AFTER ANTIETAM

Visiting **McClellan's camp** in early October the president urged him to **pursue Lee** across the Potomac River. **McClellan's response** was to prove **too slow for Lincoln to tolerate**.